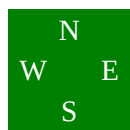


**Board 1**

North Deals  
None Vul

♠ Q 9 3  
♥ J 9 8  
♦ Q 10 7 2  
♣ K 7 5

♠ A J 5  
♥ A 6 3  
♦ A K 6  
♣ J 10 9 2



♠ K 10 8 6 2  
♥ Q 10 4  
♦ J 8 4 3  
♣ 6

♠ 7 4  
♥ K 7 5 2  
♦ 9 5  
♣ A Q 8 4 3

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1NT   | Pass | 2♣    |
| Pass     | 2♦    | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass     | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3NT by North  
at trick one. Do you win or hold up?

You should assume that East holds the ♠K.

If you take the ♠A right now your ♠J 5 will provide a second stopper if it is East who gets the lead. However, if West gets the lead he will play through your holding and you may lose 4 ♠ tricks.

If you hold up you can expect West to play another ♠ through your ♠A J and East will then establish the suit. However, in doing so he will remove any ♠ held by West.

The answer key lies in the ♣ suit. You will be finessing through East, so West is the only defender who can get the lead in ♣s. Therefore you must hold up on ♠s until the third round.

If you win the first ♠ West will play a ♠ through your ♠J 5 when he wins the ♣K. East will then swamp you with ♠s.

But, if you hold up your ♠A until the third round, West will have no ♠ left when he wins the ♣K.

With no 4-card Major suit you respond 2♦ to partner's Stayman bid. Partner now bids 2NT.

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With a full 17 points you accept partner's game invitation and bid 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠6 on which West plays the ♠Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

You need 3 more tricks, obviously coming from the ♣ suit.

But the burning question right now is what do you do

**Board 3**

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q 3  
♥ K 7  
♦ A J 10 4  
♣ K 8 6 5

♠ 8 7

♥ A 9 8 6 2

♦ K 7 5

♣ Q J 3



♠ K J 6 5 2

♥ Q J 10 4 3

♦ 8 3

♣ 4

♠ 10 9 4

♥ 5

♦ Q 9 6 2

♣ A 10 9 7 2

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
| 1NT      | Pass  | 2♦   | Pass  |
| 2♥       | Pass  | 2♠   | Pass  |
| 4♠       |       |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♠ by East

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4

When you are 5-5 in the Majors you can transfer to either suit. Most will say transfer first to ♥s when you have invitational strength. So you bid 2♦.

Partner says 2♥;

When you are 5-5 in the Majors you can transfer to either suit. Most will say transfer first to ♥s when you have invitational strength. So you bid 2♦.

Partner says 2♥;

Now you show your other 5-card Major by bidding 2♠. This one hits the spot and partner raises to 4♠.

East plays 4♠. South leads the ♥5. North takes the ♥A and returns the ♥6 which South ruffs. South then plays the ♦2.

That's an odd way to show the second ♥ loser but you get the idea. You've lost 2 tricks already and it doesn't look like you can dodge the ♣A. Soooooo, you cannot afford to lose a ♦ trick.

Take dummy's ♦A and then play ♠A, ♠K, relaxing a little when both defenders follow suit both times.

Play your three high ♥s, discarding all three ♦s from dummy. Play your ♣ toward the ♣K. South will no doubt grab his ♣A but the rest will be yours, since you can ruff your ♦ loser in dummy.

It was a little unlucky to suffer that early ♥ ruff.

But it was very very lucky that the ruffer happened to be the defender with three trumps!

That meant you could pull trumps with two pulls, leaving that one important one in dummy.